Topics for May - August 2018

Ver 1.3

Jul, 5th

Part I Warming-up

1. Basic Information

Name

May I have your full name, please?
Do you have an English name?
Who gave you this name?
Do you like your name?
Does your Chinese name have any special (or particular) meaning? What is it?
Is this name Popular in China?
Would you consider changing your name in the future?
Is changing one's name difficult in China?
Are there any traditions in naming babies in China?
What names are most common in China?

Work/study

Do you study or work?
(work)
What do you do?
Why did you choose to do that job?
Do you like your job? Is it interesting?
Will you continue doing this job in the future?
What are your responsibilities at work?
Have you received training before/ during this job?
Which day of a week would you like to change, and how would you like it to be?
Would you feel sad if you left your job?
Do you miss being a student?
What is your dream job?
Do you want to do management jobs in the future?
(study)
What's your major? (What subject(s) are you studying?) Do you like your major? Why/ Why not.
Do many students in your country study that major (study)?
Do you want to change your major? Why?
What do you want to do when you graduate?
Where do you prefer to study?
Do you prefer to study in the morning or in the afternoon? Why?

Are you looking forward to working?
What do you do during the process of long-time learning?
Why do some people find it difficult to focus in the morning?
What do you do to improve your learning efficiency?
What's the best period of time for you to study in a day?
Do you like to study alone or with your friends?
Who do you usually study with?

Hometown

Where is your hometown?
Is it a big city or a small place?
Do you like your hometown?
Is it suitable for the elderly or the young to live? Is your hometown suitable for growing up?
What are the things you dislike about your hometown?
Do you want to live there for a long time (or forever)?
Will you move to other places?
Are there any changes happening in your hometown? Do you like it?
How many people are there in your family (hometown)? Where do they come from?
How about the transportation in this city?
Does everyone need to learn how to drive?
Do your parents live in the same city?
Do you think your hometown is a good city, and why?
Recommend a place in your hometown.
Are there anything special about your hometown?
What do you want to introduce to the travelers to your hometown?
Are there any beautiful views in your hometown?

Accommodation (house/flat, apartment)

Where do you live?
Do you live in a house or flat/dorm? How long have you lived there?
Is it a convenient place to live in?
Are there any facilities in the place you live in?
How about the transportation in the city you live in?
Which one do you prefer, apartment or house?
Which room do you like best in your apartment? Please describe the room you live in.
What do you dislike about this place?
What's the difference between where you are living now and where you have lived in the past?
Do you know anyone there?
What kind of people live nearby?
Are there any famous people living near your home?
Will you choose to drive your car to other places? What are the advantages and disadvantages of it?
Who do you live with? Do you live with your parents?

Do you like the place where you live?
Do you think it is a suitable place for living?
Is it a suitable place to raise a child?
Which one is more suitable for kids, a small size-family or a big-size family?
Do you know your neighbors well?
Is there any good sides and downsides of the place that you live in?
Will you stay in that place for a very long time?
Would you like to change where you live? Where do you want to live in the future?
Is it suitable for kids and the elderly to live?
Which room does your family spend most of the time in?
Would you invite people to your place?
What would you do after you invite people to your place?

2. Others

Travel

Do you like travelling?
What was your last time you went travelling like?
do you like travelling by air?
In which season do you prefer to travel?
What are the benefits of travelling?
Would you say your country welcomes travelers (or tourists)?
Would you say your country is a good place for them?

Space travel

Do you want to travel to the outer space?
what would you do if you had that opportunity?
Do you think it's necessary to see other planets?

Maps

Do you often use a map?
Who taught you how to use a map?
Do you prefer electronic maps or paper maps?

Save money

Did you save money when you were young?
Have you ever given money to other children?
Do you think parents should teach children to save money?
Do parents give children pocket money in China?
What are some good ways of saving money?

Plants

Do you keep plants at home?

Do you know anything about growing a plant?
Do Chinese people send plants as gifts?
What plants did you grow when you were young?

New food

Have you ever tried foreign food?
Do you like to try new food?
What kinds of new food have you tried recently?
What kinds of foreign food are popular in your country?
Do you like any food from countries near China?
Do you have any experience of trying bad food?

Being bored

What do you do when you feel bored?
What kinds of things are boring to you?
Do you think young people are more likely to get bored?
What would you do if you felt bored when you were young?

Watches

What was your first watch like?
How often do you wear a watch?
What kinds of watches do you like to wear?
Do people in your country still wear watches?
Why do some people choose to buy and wear expensive watches?

Spare time

What do you usually do when you are free (in your spare time/leisure time)?
Do you like to spend time with your family or friends?
What do you and your family like to do in spare time?
Do you think you will spend more time with your family in the future?

Dream jobs

What is your dream job?
What was the dream job for you when you were young?
Have you changed your mind on your dream job?
What do you plan to do in the future?
What kinds of jobs are popular in China?
Have you had full-time or part-time job before?

Celebrities

Who is your favorite celebrity in China？
Do you like any foreign celebrities？

Would you want to be a celebrity in the future?
Do you think we should protect famous people's privacy?
How do celebrities influence their fans in China?
In general, how do people become famous?
What kinds of people become famous?
Do you think to be famous a person needs to have some special talent or ability?
What are some general qualities of famous people? Do they have any qualities that are different from ordinary people?
Please compare how people become celebrities today with years ago, like 30 or 50 years.
Can you give me some examples of celebrities in your grandfather's time (e.g. when your grandfather was young) to the kinds of people who are famous today.

Sports

Do you play any sports?
Do you like to watch sport games on TV?
Do you have a favorite sports star?
What kinds of sports are popular in China?
What kinds of sports would you like to try in the future?
Do you like extreme sports? Would you like to try?

Sleep

How many hours do you sleep for every day?
Is it necessary to take a nap every day?
Do old people sleep a lot? Why?
What time do you usually go to bed?
Do you always have a good sleep?

Gifts

Do you like to give gifts?
Do you prefer giving gifts or receiving them?
What are some popular gifts in China?
Who did you give the gift to last time?
How often do you buy others gifts?
Do you like to send expensive gifts?

Dictionaries

How often do you use your dictionary?
Do you like a paper dictionary or an electronic one?
What kinds of dictionaries have you used before?
How will dictionaries change in the future?

Outdoor activities

What do you do in your spare time?
Do you like outdoor activities?
What outdoor activities do you like the most?
How often do you do that?
What outdoor sports do you like? (Why?)
How much time do you spend outdoors every week?
How often do you do outdoor activities?

Animals

Why do some people keep pets at home?
What kinds of animals do you like?
Have you ever had a pet before?
Do you like to see animals in the zoo?
What is the most popular animal in China?

Physical exercise

What kinds of exercises do you do?
Do you think children should play sports regularly?
What was your favorite sport when you were young?
Do you like extreme sports?
What kinds of exercises are popular in your country?

Apps

What kinds of apps do you often use?
What kinds of apps would you like to have in the future?
What's the most popular app in your country?
What was the first app you used?
Do old people in your country like to use apps?

Music and concerts

When do you listen to music?
How much time do you spend listening to music every day?
What kinds of music do you like to listen to?
What's your favorite kind of music?
Have you ever been to a concert before?
Are concerts ever held in your hometown?
Would you like to go to a concert in the future?
Would you prefer to watch a concert on TV or to attend a live concert?

Meal/Eating out

When do you have meals?
Who do you often have meals with?

Do you often eat out?
Do you like to eat at home or outside?
What's your favorite restaurant?

News/Newspapers/Magazines

Are you interested in the news?
Do you care about the news?
Why do you want to know the latest news?
Where do you usually get news? Do you ever get news from the Internet?
What types of news do you like (local/ national/ international, political/ economical/ entertainment)?
How do you usually find the news?
How important do you think the news is? How important is it to you to get the news every day?
Would you say that news affects your life very much?
Are old people and young people (Chinese and foreigners) interested in the same (kinds of) news?
Do you prefer to read newspapers or watch TV to get your news?
Do you read newspapers? How often do you read them? What kind do you mostly read?
What sections of the newspaper do you usually read?
Which do you prefer reading, magazines or newspapers?
How old were you when you first started to read newspapers?
Do you think it's important to read newspapers?
What different types of newspaper are there in China?
What are some methods that newspapers use to attract readers?
What influence do you think newspapers have on society?
Do you think magazines and newspaper will exist 50 years from now?

Friends

Do you remember your friends in primary school? Why?
What do you do with friends?
How do you make friends?
Do you have many friends?
Do you like chatting with friends online?
Do you prefer to hang out with several good friends or a lot of friends?

Weather/season

What's the weather like today?
What kind of weather do you like (best). Do you like rainy or sunny days?
What do you usually do on rainy (sunny) days?
What's the weather usually like in your hometown? Is it usually good?
Does weather have any influence on you?
Do you discuss weather with others?
Do you think climate in China is different from that in the past? Do you think the climate in China is getting worse/better than before?

Which season do you like best, and why?
What do you/Chinese do in your favorite season?
Which one do you prefer, a place with changeable seasons or a place with an unaltered season?
Do you agree that weather will affect people?
Do you like extreme weathers?

(Sunny)

Do you like sunshine?
Do you like a place full of sunshine?
Are there any technologies relating to sun nowadays?
Are there many sunny days in your hometown?

(Rainy)

Does it rain much in China? (Where? When?)
Where does it rain the most in China?
Is there any part of China where it doesn't rain much? (Where?)
When (in what month/season) does it rain most in your hometown?
What about the other parts of China? (In which season does it rain most in other parts of China?)
Can you remember any time when it rained particularly heavily in your hometown? (When?)

Advertisements

Do you prefer to get advertisements by listening or watching?
What kind of advertisement do you like the most?
Where do you often see the advertisement?
Do you like the advertisement on TV?
Do you think advertisements online are useful?
Are there many advertisements in your country?
Why do you think there are so many advertisements now?
What are the various places where we see advertisements?
How do you feel about advertisements?
Will advertisements trigger shopping desires?

Transport/traffic

How did you get here today?
Why did you choose that form of transport?
Do you prefer travelling by car or taxi?
Do you like travelling by car?
What was the last time you took a taxi?
How is the public transportation where you live?
What is your favorite way to travel?
What do you think needs to be done in your city to improve the public transportation?
Do you like taking trains?
Are there many trains in China?
How often do you take trains/buses?

Have you met any interesting people while you were on a train?
What's the most popular means of transportation in your hometown?
Would you ride bikes to work in the future?
Do you prefer public transport or private one?
Can you compare the advantages of planes and trains?
Is driving to work popular in your country?
Do you think people will drive more in the future?
What will become the most popular means of transportation in China?
Do people travel by taxi?
When was the last time you took a taxi?
Are there subways in your city? Why do we need them?
Should everyone have their own cars?
Describe your last experience of taking a taxi.
(bus)
How often do you take the bus?
When was the first time you took a bus?
Is it convenient to take the bus in your city?
Do people in your country take the bus?

Emails/letters

Do you write many letters or emails?
Who do you usually write to?
Do you prefer phone calls or email?
Do you often receive emails?
On what occasions would you write letters?
Do you prefer to write letters by hand or with a computer?
What are the differences between emails and letters?
Is it hard to think of what to write?
What types of letters are hard(est) to write/reply to?
What kinds of emails (or letters) do you receive that make you feel excited?
Do you think people will still write letters in the future?
Will email replace letter in the future?
How do you communicate with others at work, by email or face-to-face?
Will you text people back?
When can't people answer your phone?

Family

How often do you meet with your family?
How do you spend the time with your family?
Do you want to live with your family in the future?
Are you close to all of your family members?
How has your family influenced you?

Boat

Have you ever travelled by boat?
Do you like boats?
Would you like to have your own boat?
Is boat trip popular in your country?

School

(elementary school)

How old were you when you started school?
How did you get to school each day?
Are you still in contact with any of the friends you had in primary school?
What were some of the most popular activities in primary school?
Have you ever returned to see your old school again?
What was the first school you attended?
What subjects do you like and dislike?

(high school)

Do you like your high school?
Which subject do you like and dislike?
Do you still contact with your friends in high school?
What happened on your first day of high school?
What is your high school like?

(college)

What was your feeling about the first day you went to school/college?
Which school are you studying in?
Why did you choose this university/school?
Which city do you study in? Why did you select this city?
Do you like your professors and classmates? Why?

Punctuality/time management

Do you like to wait for others? How would you feel?
Are you punctual?
Is being punctual important?
What excuses do you (people) use when you are late?
What is the advantage of being punctual?
How do you remind yourself to be on time?
Why are some people always late?
Are you ever late for anything?
What excuses do you use when you are late?
Do you think people these days are as punctual as they were in the past?
Do you like to wear a watch?
How is your time management? Are you good at organizing time?

What do you do to improve your time management? Do you think planning is important?
Do you think children should learn to manage time?
How would you teach your children time management?
Do old people and young people manage time in a similar way?

Teachers

Do you like any teacher of yours?
What kinds of teacher do you like best?
Have you ever had bad teachers before?
Do you still keep in touch with your teachers?
Do you think it's important to like your teachers?
Do you want to be a teacher?
What qualities should a good teacher have?
Do you have a favorite teacher?
Do you want to be a teacher in the future?
What kinds of teachers do you like?
Do you think teachers should be angry at students or not?
Do you like strict teachers?
What's the different between young and old teachers?
Is it important for teachers to interact with students frequently?
What's the most important part in your study, teachers or classmates?

Part II & III Cue Cards and Expansive Questions

1. People

访客

Describe a visitor in your home (a time when someone visited your home*)
You should say:
Who this visitor was
When he/she visited your home
What you did
Why he/she came to visit
And explain whether you like him/her or not

话唠

Describe some who is talkative
You should say:
Who this person is
How you knew this person
What this person likes to talk about
How you feel about this person

童年基友 1

Describe a childhood friend of yours
You should say:
When you met him/her
Where you met him/her
What you did with your friend
How you felt about the friend

喜剧演员

Describe a popular comic actor/actress in your country
You should say:
Who he/she is
How you knew him/her
What comedies have he/she performed
And explain why he/she is popular?

受欢迎人物

Describe a popular person (you know)
You should say:
Who this person is
What kind of person he/she is

Why you think this person he/she is popular
How long you have known each other
How you got to know him/her
How this person influences the public
And explain how you feel about this person

运动员

Describe a sports person (athlete) you admire (you know)
You should say:
Who he/she is
What he/she does
How you knew him/her
What you know about his/her life story
Why he is famous
And explain how much you know about sports

名人

Describe a famous person (that you are interested in) (in your country).
You should say:
Who this person is;
How you know this person;
How this person looks like;
What this person is famous for;
What sort of life they had before they became famous;
How this person became famous;
And explain why you like this person. (why he/she is important)

好家长

Describe someone who you think is a good parent.
You should say:
Who the person is
What kind of person he/she is
How you know this person
Why you think he/she is good
And explain how you feel about him/her (why you think they are a good parent).

2. Places/Architectures

喜欢与友人同去之地

Describe a place in your city or town that you like to visit with your friends.
You should say:
Where this place is
When the last time you went there was
Who you like to go with
And explain why you like to go there.

常拜访之地

Describe a place where you often visit with your friends (or family)
You should say:
Where the place is
How you know the place
How you go there
Why you want to visit

安静之地

Describe a quiet place you found
You should say:
Where it is
When you found it
How you found it
How often you go there
What it is like
And explain how you felt about the place

喜爱的建筑

Describe a building you like (dislike)
You should say:
Where it is
What it is used for
What it looks like
And explain why you like or dislike it

需改进的场所

Describe a public place (facility) that you think needs improvements
You should say:
Where the place is
What it is like
Why you think it needs improvements
When you go there

What you like and dislike in the public place
And explain how to make it better

想定居的地方

Describe a city or country you want to live (or work) (the most) in the future
You should say:
Where the country or city is
Why you want to live or work there
Who you like to live or work with
And explain what you will do to achieve your dreams

想要的娱乐设施

Describe a leisure facility (cinema theater sports center) you would like to have in your hometown
You should say:
What it is
Where it is
When you go there
Why you would like to have this facility in your hometown
How the facility would change your life
And explain how you would feel about it

想要的房子

Describe a dream home you would like to have (a dream house or apartment you want to live in).
You should say:
Where you are living now
Where it is
What your dream home is like
When you want to live in there
why you like the dream home
And explain what you would do to get it (why you think it's your dream home)

3. Experiences & Events

改变计划

Describe a time you had to change your plan (you changed your mind)
You should say:
When this happened
What made you change the plan
What the new plan was
And explain how you felt about the change

第一支手机

Describe the time you received your first cellphone (describe what difference has it made when you first receive your phone)
You should say:
When it was
Where you were
How you got it
Who gave it to you
What it was like
And explain how you felt about it

童年基友 2

Describe a time you spent with your friend in childhood
You should say:
Who this friend is
How you knew about each other
What you did together
And explain why you remembered it.

快乐时光

Describe a happy experience you had before
You should say:
Where you were
When it happened
Who you were with
What you did
And explain why you felt happy

公共交通旅行

Describe a trip that you went on by public transportation
You should say:
Where you went
What means of transportation you took

Who you were with
And explain how you felt about the trip

想参加比赛

Describe a competition (talent show, etc) you want to take part in
You should say:
What the competition is
How you knew it
What you need to prepare for it
And explain why you want to attend it

朋友做过你没做

Describe something interesting that your friend has done but you haven't
You should say:
What it was
Where your friend did it
When your friend did it
And explain why it was interesting

帮助专心

Describe something you do to keep yourself concentrated in work/stury
You should say:
What it is
How often you do it
When you started doing it
And explain why it helped yourself concentrate?

特殊衣服

Describe a time you wore a type of clothes for a special occasion (describe something you wear in a special occasion)
You should say:
What the occasion was
What you wore
Where you bought the clothes
And explain what other people at the occasion thought of your clothes

参加 party

Describe a party that you joined
You should say:
When it took place
Where it was
Whose party it was

What you did there
And how you felt about the party

街市购物

Describe a time that you were shopping in a street market
You should say:
When it was
Where you were
What you bought
How you felt about the shopping experience

未来旅行计划

Describe a trip that you plan to go on in the near future.
You should say:
Where this place is
Who you would like to go with
What would you do there
And explain why you would like to go there

与老亲人做事

Describe something you enjoy doing with an old person in your family.
You should say:
What it is
How often you do it
Who you do it with
Why you enjoy doing it with this person

优质服务

Describe an occasion where you received a good service (from a company or shop)
You should say:
What the service was
When and where it happened
Whom you were together with
How you felt about it
And explain why you think it was good service

庆祝重要事件

Describe an important event that you celebrated
You should say:
What it was
Where it happened
Why it was important

How people felt about it

不得不礼貌

Describe a situation where you had to be polite
You should say:
What it is
What you did to be polite
Who were there
Why you had to be polite
And explain how you felt about it afterwards

听说的轶闻

Describe an impressive/memorable story you heard from someone
You should say:
What this story was
When you heard about it
Who told you this story
And explain why you were impressed/memorable by it

不寻常的一餐

Describe an unforgettable dinner/an unusual meal
You should say:
When the dinner was
Where the dinner was
Who you dined with
And explain why it is unforgettable/unusual

感兴趣的历史

Describe a historical era(/period) you are interested in
You should say:
When this era was
How you learned about it
What it is famous for
What happened during that period
And explain why are you interested in this era

花钱少的外出

Describe a special day out（a day out/a special day which does not cost too much）
You should say:
What day it was
Where you went on that day
What you did

Who you went out with
And explain why it was special to you

离家旅行

Describe a holiday/vacation (away from home) you would like to take in the future
You should say:
When and where you would like to go
Who you would like to go with
What you would like to do on this holiday
And explain why you would like to take the holiday

帮助他人

Describe an occasion when you helped a person
You should say:
What the situation was
Who you helped
How you helped him/her
And explain how you felt after helping them.

好决定

Describe a (good) decision someone made.
You should say:
Who made it
What was the decision
When it was made
And explain why it was a good decision.

4. Objects & Items

有趣的动物

Describe an interesting animal
You should say:
What it looks like
When you saw/knew it for the first time
Where it lives
And explain why it is interesting

有趣的学科

Describe an interesting subject (your favorite subject) that you learned at school
You should say:
What the subject was
What your teacher was like
When and where you study(ed) it
How long you learned this subject
And explain why it was interesting to you (why it is/was your favorite)

丢失要物

Describe something important that you lost in the past
You should say:
When this happened
Where you lost it
What it was
What you did after it was lost
And explain why it was important

想尝试的运动

describe a sport that you have watched (on TV) before and you want to try
you should say:
what it is
when you first watched the sport
what you like about the sport
and explain why you would like to try this sport

有趣工作

Describe an interesting job that you want to have in the future
You should say:
What it is
How you can find this job
What qualities it requires
And explain why it is an interesting job

数学课技能

Describe a useful skill you learned in a math class in your primary/high school.
You should say:
What the skill was
How you learned it
Who taught you
And why it was useful to you

想换的东西

Describe something you own that you want to replace
You should say:
What it is
Where it is
How you got it
And explain why you want to replace it

最爱的季节

Describe your favorite season of a year
You should say:
What it is
When it is
How the weather is like
Why you like this season
What activities you usually do during it
Why you like it
How different kinds of weather would affect people

童年玩具

Describe a toy you had (that you received) when you were a child.
You should say:
What the toy was
When you had it
Who gave it to you
What it was like
How you used this
And explain how you felt about it.

好照片

Describe a (good) photo you have taken (/of you taken by someone)
You should say:
Where you took it
When you took the photo

What/who is in the photo
And explain how you felt about the photo
(where it was taken
When it was taken
Who took it for you
And why it was unforgettable for you)

重要水域

Describe an important river/lake(/are of water) in your country
You should say:
What this river is called
Where it is
How you knew about it
How long/big it is
And explain why it is important

城市发展

Describe a recent development (such as new roads, shopping centers) in your city
You should say:
What this development is
How it could help people
What benefits it could bring
Where you saw it
And explain whether it changes your life or not
(and explain how you felt about it)

科技

Describe a piece of technology you like using except computers
You should say:
What this technology is
When it was invented
How you learned about it
How often you use it
And explain what difference it brings to your life

省钱买东西

Describe something special that you saved money to buy (a time that you saved money for something*)
You should say:
What this thing was
Why it was special to you
How much it cost you
And explain how you felt after you bought it

家具

Describe a piece of furniture (you like)
You should say:
What kind of furniture it is
When you saw the furniture
What it looks like
Where you put this furniture
And explain why you like (use) the furniture

学校不教的技能

Describe an important skill which cannot be learned at school (something important that you learned not from school or class)
You should say:
What the skill is
Why it cannot be learned at school
Why it is important
Whether it was difficult to learn
How we learned it

体育比赛

Describe a sport (game) you like(d) to watch (you've watched).
You should say
What it is (was)
When and where you (like(d) to) watch it
Whom you (like(d) to) watch it with
And explain why you (like(d) to) watch it?

5. Media & Art

喜爱的杂志

Describe a magazine that you like (watching)
You should say:
What the magazine is
When you started reading this magazine
What the content is
And explain why you like this magazine

最爱的歌

Describe a favorite song of yours (a song that means something special to you)
You should say:
What this song is about
When you listened to this song for the first time
How often you listen to this song
And explain why you think it is your favorite?

最爱的电视节目

Describe your favorite TV drama series (a TV drama series you have watched, a TV program)
You should say
What name it is
Who the main actor/actress is
What it is about
When you first watched it
(what part do you like the most)
And explain why you like it

常去网站

Describe a website you like to visit.
You should say:
When you found it;
What it is about;
How often you visit it;
And explain why you like this website.

重要的信

Describe an important letter (you received).
You should say:
Who sent the letter
What it was about
why it is important
when you read it

And explain how you feel about it (why it is exciting)

看广告购物

Describe an ad that helped you buy something

You should say:

What it was

Where you saw or heard about it

What it was about

And explain why you wanted to buy it.